Students must choose where their software runs for their university thesis and for their future careers. Many students choose poorly and get unexpected cloud bills or broken local hardware. Keith Alan Speirs and Gerald Ebacuado opened Week 1 of Professor Lorico's seminar at José Rizal University. Our presentation was "Cloud-First vs. Self-Hosted: Deployment Strategies for Future Tech Professionals." We gave students simple rules to choose their infrastructure. This paper evaluates our presentation against the five criteria of the course rubric.

We used simple analogies to explain difficult concepts clearly. In the Vehicle Test, self-hosting is like a project car in your garage. You own the car, but you must buy tools and repair all the broken parts. Cloud hosting is like a leased car. The company repairs the engine, and you pay only for fuel and travel distance. We also clarified cloud security with the Shared Responsibility Model. The cloud provider secures the physical data centers, power, cooling, and server hardware. The student engineer secures the operating system, firewalls, access rules, data, and software code. We analyzed costs and operational risks. Self-hosting is a capital expense with high initial hardware costs, continuous electrical power, and cooling needs. Cloud hosting is an operating expense with pay-as-you-go billing, but unmonitored idle resources cause high costs. Cloud computing risks sudden financial loss from endless loops and scraper attacks. Self-hosting risks hardware failure, local power cuts, and home internet limits like Carrier-Grade NAT. Our five-step guide directs students to check visitor traffic, project budget, allowable downtime, data location, and maintenance time before deployment.

We proved these principles with three student projects. A personal portfolio website uses cloud static storage and edge caching for zero cost and zero maintenance. A school garden project uses a self-hosted mini-computer to ingest sensor readings every five seconds without cloud API fees. A school ticket store uses cloud serverless computers to handle three thousand concurrent buyers without crashing home network routers.

Our writing used short, active sentences and precise technical words. During self-review, we found placeholder text on slides fifteen and sixteen. We corrected this error in this paper. We specified exact metrics: eighty to one hundred twenty watts of power draw, internet upload limits, hardware replacement costs, and cloud network transfer fees.
We managed our project schedule with discipline. We spoke first in Week 1 to set a high standard. We controlled our twenty-minute time window precisely across all topics and audience questions. In conclusion, students should avoid rigid choices and build hybrid systems. They should host public interfaces on the cloud for reliability and keep high-frequency data and private testing on local hardware.